LESSON 7

Frère Jacques

An old French round about Brother John, who sleeps through the morning bells. Sing it as a round: a second voice starts two bars later.

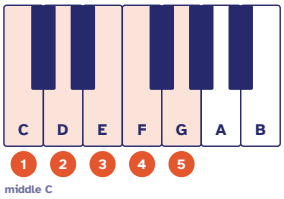
IN THIS SONG **every line twice** **hands take turns** **a letter on each line's first note**

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

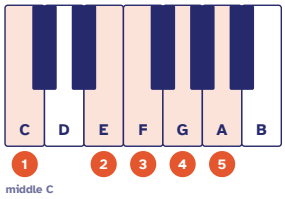
1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it in French, then as a round: your teacher starts two bars after you.

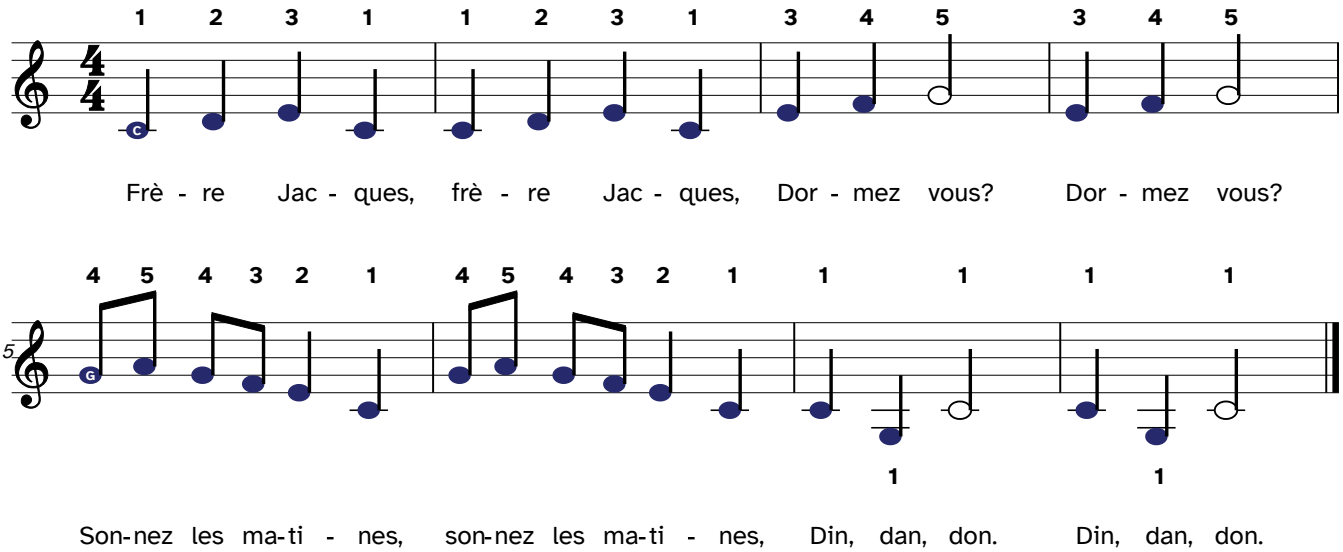
LINES 1–2 · C POSITION



LINE 3 · THE HAND OPENS



Lines 1 and 2: the C position. Thumb on middle C, 1 2 3 4 5 up to G.
Line 3: the hand opens. Thumb stays on C; 2 3 4 5 move up one key, so G A G F E C is 4 5 4 3 2 1.
Din, dan, don: the low G is the left hand's thumb.



THE WOW MOMENT
Din, dan, don: the left thumb rings the low bell. Then play it as a **round** with your teacher: two tunes at once make harmony.

- [ ] **Listened and pointed**
- [ ] **Sang it in French**
- [ ] **Rang the low bell**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

NEW IN THIS SONG

Hands take turns. Every line comes twice: the right hand sings it, then the left hand answers an octave lower. Letters now sit only on the first note of each line.

More in the Handbook: Pitch 2 · The staff and the notes

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME

4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.

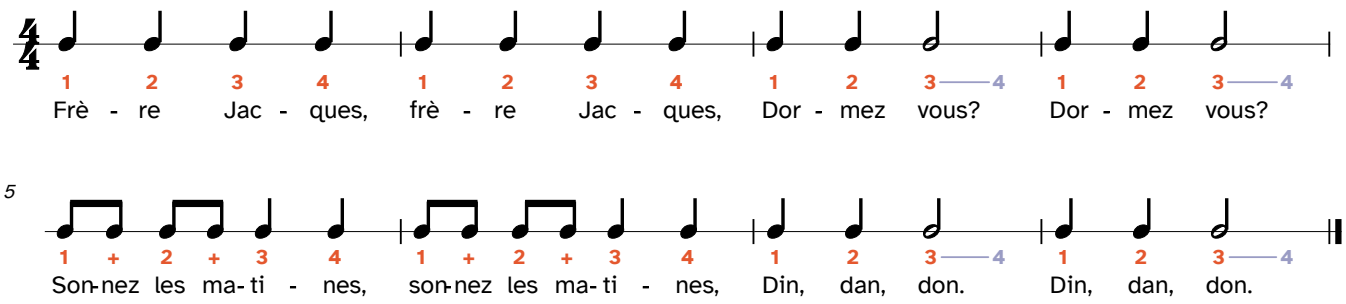
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

crotchet: walk — 1 beat

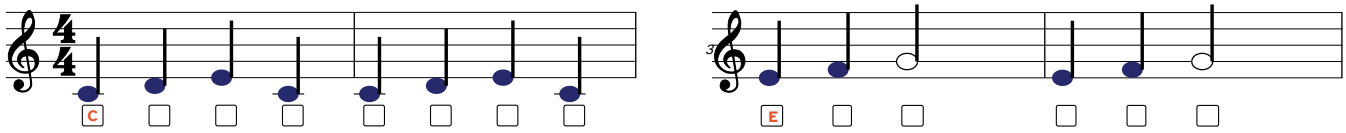
two quavers: run-ning — 1 beat

minim: hold — 2 beats



THE NOTES

Only the first note of each line keeps its letter now. Write the others: count up or down from the one given.



SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays the song with one wrong note. Put up your hand when you hear it, then find it on the page.

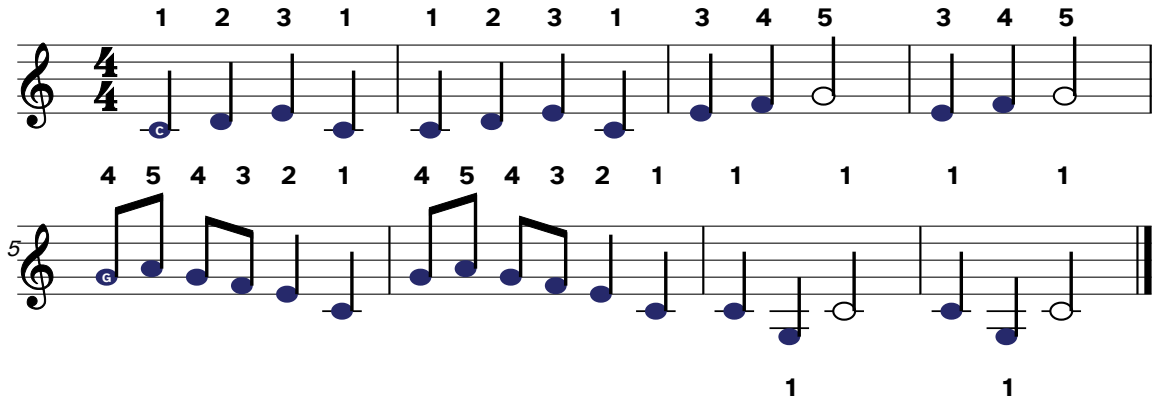
- ☐ **Said it in time**
- ☐ **Clapped and counted**
- ☐ **Wrote the letter names**
- ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

3 Play it

Right hand first, the whole song; then the hands take turns, line by line.

Right hand: the C position, opening to A on line 3 (the keyboards on page 1). **Left hand:** the same shape an octave lower on the King's staff, 5 on C.

R RIGHT HAND the whole song



L R BOTH HANDS take turns: right hand, then left hand an octave lower



4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can sing it in French ☐ I can sing it as a round

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
Right hand				
Taking turns				

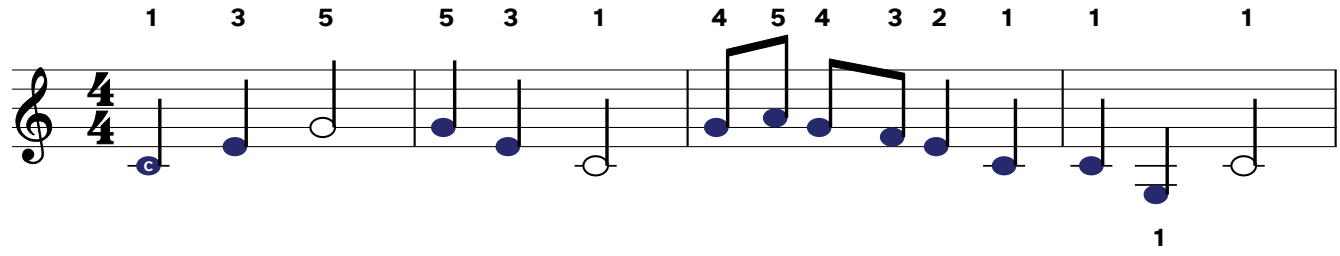
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

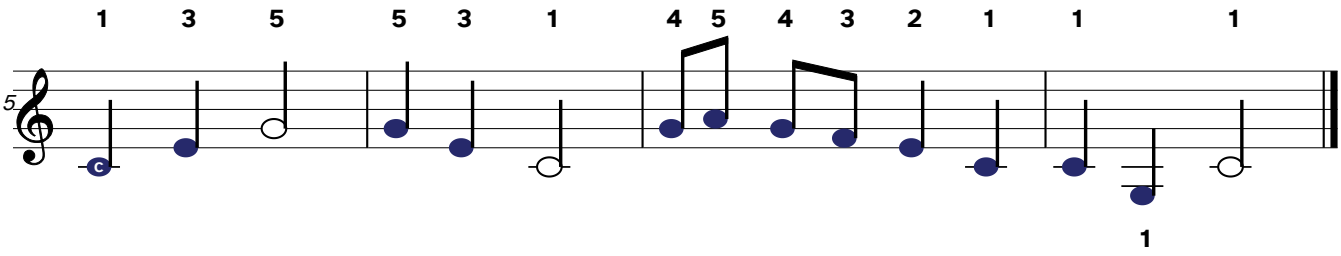
+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

MORNING BELLS

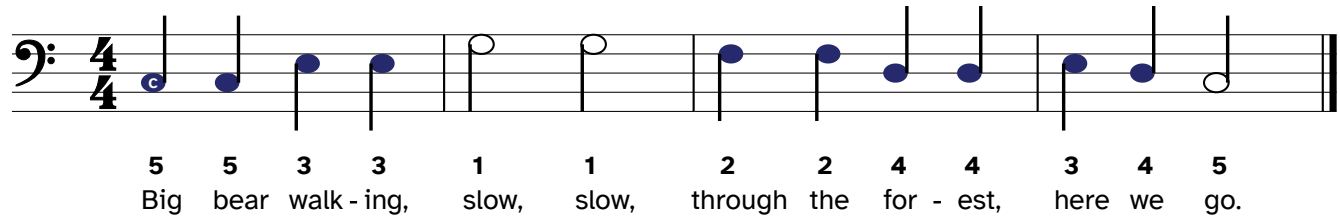
Bright and ringing: the bells climb C E G and fall back down.





BEAR WALK

Slow and heavy, a peek at Lesson 8: the left hand plays the tune, low on the King's staff.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **Sleepy: slow and soft**
- ☐ **Alarm clock: fast and loud**
- ☐ **Up high: an octave higher**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Hands take turns, twice
3. Play it with the band
4. Your choice: a tune from this page

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Morning Bells** ☐ **Played Bear Walk**